

The Beginnings of European Settlements (Portuguese -> Dutch -> English -> French) - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

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Original deterministic study visual: labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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The Beginnings of European Settlements (Portuguese -> Dutch -> English -> French) - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement best distinguishes maritime exploration from territorial empire?

A. Opening a route establishes contact; empire requires enforceable jurisdiction, revenue and force. B. A factory is already a territorial province. C. Any ocean voyage automatically creates sovereignty. D. A royal charter transfers Indian land to the company.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Cape voyage opened direct contact, while sovereignty required later Indian political and fiscal conditions.

Evidence anchor: Conceptual stages.

Q2. The Portuguese Estado da India was best described as:

A. A modern nation-state with continuous Asian borders. B. A dispersed Crown administrative-military network of forts, fleets and royal factories. C. A privately owned Portuguese joint-stock company identical to the VOC. D. A Mughal naval department headquartered at Goa.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Estado was a Crown formation under a viceroy or governor; distance and local negotiation limited central control.

Evidence anchor: Estado da India.

Q3. What was the primary function of the cartaz?

A. To grant the EIC duty-free Bengal trade. B. To charter the French Compagnie des Indes. C. To license and regulate shipping under Portuguese maritime coercion. D. To appoint a VOC governor at Pulicat.

Answer: C. Explanation: Cartaz was a Portuguese naval pass, not a farman, charter or company appointment.

Evidence anchor: Cartaz.

Q4. Which chronology is correct?

A. Goa capture 1505 -> Calicut 1510 -> capital 1661. B. Calicut 1510 -> Goa capital 1511 -> Goa capture 1530. C. Goa capital 1498 -> Calicut 1510 -> Cochin 1530. D. Calicut 1498 -> Goa capture 1510 -> Goa capital 1530.

Answer: D. Explanation: Capture, administrative creation and capital transfer are separate milestones.

Evidence anchor: Portuguese chronology.

Q5. Why is calling the Estado da India a modern nation-state misleading?

A. Its authority was nodal and Crown-centred, spread across forts and sea lanes rather than continuous territory. B. It had no connection to the Portuguese Crown. C. It consisted only of missionaries and no trade. D. It exercised uniform inland administration across India.

Answer: A. Explanation: The network exercised public power but lacked modern bounded territorial continuity.

Evidence anchor: Political form.

Q6. Which Xavier statement is accurate?

A. He founded the EIC and died at Surat. B. He was a founding Jesuit, died off China and his remains are in Goa. C. He was a Dutch missionary at Nagapattinam. D. He died in Goa and was buried at Pulicat.

Answer: B. Explanation: The place-of-death versus place-of-remains distinction is the central UPSC trap.

Evidence anchor: Mission history.

Q7. Which combination is safely linked to Portuguese maritime networks?

A. Fort William and the Permanent Settlement. B. Pulicat and VOC spice monopoly. C. Goa printing press and the introduction of papaya, pineapple and guava. D. Pondicherry grid and Dupleix's governorship.

Answer: C. Explanation: Goa press dates to 1556; the 2025 official key confirms all three fruits.

Evidence anchor: Cultural transfer.

Q8. Which is the strongest explanation of Portuguese decline?

A. Religious policy alone caused every loss. B. The Portuguese voluntarily ended Asian trade in 1600. C. Indian rulers never resisted, so only climate mattered. D. Overextension, limited resources, company competition, European war and Asian resistance acted together.

Answer: D. Explanation: A multi-causal hierarchy avoids monocausal and stereotyped answers.

Evidence anchor: Portuguese decline.

Q9. The VOC's 1602 charter is significant because it:

A. Created a joint-stock corporation with extensive commercial and quasi-sovereign powers. B. Transferred Goa from Bijapur. C. Made Pondicherry a French presidency. D. Issued the Mughal cartaz.

Answer: A. Explanation: The VOC could wage war and make treaties, but enforcement still depended on local circumstances.

Evidence anchor: VOC structure.

Q10. Which pairing is correct?

A. Fort St George - French factory. B. Pulicat - principal Dutch Coromandel base. C. Pondicherry - Portuguese capital. D. Goa - English presidency from 1613.

Answer: B. Explanation: Pulicat is the high-frequency Dutch east-coast location.

Evidence anchor: Dutch bases.

Q11. Why were Indian textiles central to Dutch strategy?

A. Textiles were used only to pay Mughal land revenue. B. Dutch law prohibited bullion or barter. C. They served as commodities and purchasing power in intra-Asian spice trade. D. The VOC avoided all Asian trade beyond India.

Answer: C. Explanation: India was commercially central even when territorial priority lay in Indonesia.

Evidence anchor: VOC business model.

Q12. What does Colachel 1741 demonstrate?

A. The Portuguese captured Madras from the French. B. The EIC received the 1717 farman. C. The Dutch conquered Bengal territorially. D. An Indian regional state, Travancore, could defeat a European company force.

Answer: D. Explanation: The battle is strong anti-teleological evidence; Dutch trade nevertheless continued.

Evidence anchor: Indian resistance.

Q13. The EIC charter of 1600 primarily:

A. Created a corporate monopoly under English law. B. Gave Surat to England. C. Transferred Bombay from Portugal to the Company. D. Granted zamindari over Calcutta.

Answer: A. Explanation: Home charter and Indian political permission are distinct legal stages.

Evidence anchor: EIC charter.

Q14. The naval encounter at Swally in 1612 mattered because it:

A. Made the EIC emperor of Gujarat. B. Improved English bargaining credibility at the Mughal court against Portuguese influence. C. Created the French company. D. Ended all Portuguese trade in Asia.

Answer: B. Explanation: Swally changed Mughal calculations but did not transfer sovereignty.

Evidence anchor: Swally.

Q15. Sir Thomas Roe's embassy is best understood as:

A. A Dutch purchase of Bombay. B. A conquest of Agra by EIC troops. C. Diplomacy that secured or clarified commercial privileges under Mughal authority. D. A Portuguese mission to Bijapur.

Answer: C. Explanation: Roe's farman did not create territorial rule.

Evidence anchor: Mughal diplomacy.

Q16. Which place belonged to the EIC factory network in the first quarter of the seventeenth century?

A. Chicacole. B. Trichinopoly. C. Pondicherry. D. Broach.

Answer: D. Explanation: This mirrors the 2021 UPSC demand; Broach formed part of the Surat-centred network.

Evidence anchor: Factory geography.

Q17. Which sequence best describes the English Coromandel chain?

A. Masulipatnam factory -> Madras lease -> Fort St George. B. Pondicherry -> Calcutta -> Cochin. C. Surat charter -> Chandernagore -> Diu. D. Bombay lease -> Goa capture -> Pulicat.

Answer: A. Explanation: Masulipatnam preceded the 1639 Madras lease and fortification from 1640.

Evidence anchor: Coromandel.

Q18. Fort St George initially protected:

A. The VOC spice islands. B. Company warehouses, specie, staff and a growing council at Madras. C. The Portuguese viceroy at Goa. D. The French governor at Chandernagore.

Answer: B. Explanation: A fortified factory was a defensive-commercial hub, not automatic hinterland rule.

Evidence anchor: Fortification.

Q19. Which Bombay chronology is correct?

A. EIC conquest in 1600 -> Mughal farman in 1613. B. French purchase in 1664 -> Dutch transfer in 1668. C. Portuguese possession -> English Crown in 1661 -> EIC in 1668. D. Job Charnock founded Bombay in 1690.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Crown-company transfer sequence is a standard factual trap.

Evidence anchor: Bombay.

Q20. The safest statement on Calcutta's origins is:

A. Calcutta became sovereign EIC territory before Child's War. B. Job Charnock created an empty city and undisputedly founded it. C. The 1717 farman first created all three villages. D. c.1690 is a conventional Company milestone within cumulative settlement of three villages.

Answer: D. Explanation: The founder label compresses existing settlements and later acquisitions.

Evidence anchor: Calcutta.

Q21. Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman:

A. Expanded valuable commercial privileges but did not grant Diwani or sovereignty. B. Chartered the EIC in London. C. Founded the VOC. D. Transferred Bombay from the Crown.

Answer: A. Explanation: Privilege, revenue right and corporate charter must be separated.

Evidence anchor: 1717 farman.

Q22. What did Child's War reveal?

A. The EIC was territorially supreme by 1686. B. The Mughal state could defeat and discipline the EIC, which returned as a petitioner. C. The Dutch captured Goa. D. The French defeated Travancore.

Answer: B. Explanation: This is central evidence against inevitable conquest.

Evidence anchor: Child's War.

Q23. In seventeenth-century company usage, a factory was:

A. A mechanised textile mill. B. A naval pass for merchant ships. C. A trading depot with warehouses, offices and residences. D. A territorial province ruled by a governor-general.

Answer: C. Explanation: Factor meant commercial agent; manufacture was not the defining function.

Evidence anchor: Terminology.

Q24. A presidency was principally:

A. A Mughal revenue-free village. B. A Jesuit religious order. C. A Portuguese maritime pass. D. A regional council system coordinating factories, shipping, diplomacy and defence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Presidency status increased coordination without automatically creating territorial sovereignty.

Evidence anchor: Administration.

Q25. The French Compagnie des Indes was founded in:

A. 1664 under Colbert's state sponsorship. B. 1717 by Farrukhsiyar. C. 1498 by Vasco da Gama. D. 1602 by the Dutch States-General.

Answer: A. Explanation: French entry came after Portuguese, Dutch and English institutional foundations.

Evidence anchor: French company.

Q26. Which French sequence is correct?

A. Pulicat -> Nagapattinam -> Chinsura. B. Surat/Masulipatnam -> Pondicherry -> Chandernagore. C. Goa -> Diu -> Cochin. D. Surat -> Madras -> Bombay.

Answer: B. Explanation: The sequence separates French from Portuguese, Dutch and English networks.

Evidence anchor: French bases.

Q27. Dupleix is relevant to this topic mainly as:

A. The conqueror of Goa in 1510. B. The issuer of the 1717 farman. C. A bridge from commercial settlements to intervention in Indian succession politics. D. The founder of the VOC.

Answer: C. Explanation: Detailed Carnatic war chronology is bounded, but the mechanism matters.

Evidence anchor: Dupleix.

Q28. Which factor most safely explains French limits against the English?

A. A Portuguese victory at Wandiwash. B. An inherent French dislike of commerce. C. Absence of any French settlement in India. D. Discontinuous naval-financial support, state interference, European priorities and Indian alliances.

Answer: D. Explanation: Multi-causal comparison replaces national stereotypes and generalship-only explanations.

Evidence anchor: French limits.

Q29. Which comparison is accurate?

A. Portuguese Crown Estado; Dutch VOC; English EIC; French state-sponsored Compagnie. B. All four began as Indian farmans. C. All four were identical private firms. D. Only the Portuguese had any public power.

Answer: A. Explanation: Institutional form shaped finance and strategy but did not mechanically determine outcome.

Evidence anchor: Company comparison.

Q30. Why is the factory-to-empire sequence non-inevitable?

A. Every charter contained automatic Indian tax rights. B. Each transition required permission, finance, fortification, alliances, crisis and enforceable victory. C. European weapons guaranteed victory in every battle. D. Indian merchants had no role in settlements.

Answer: B. Explanation: Failed wars, restrictions and continuing enclaves demonstrate alternative outcomes.

Evidence anchor: Anti-teleology.

Q31. Which example most directly shows ruler agency?

A. Factories manufactured steam engines. B. Bullion flowed because no Indian goods were available. C. Aurangzeb's government defeated the EIC in Child's War and restored trade on submission. D. The EIC chartered itself without a Crown.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rulers could grant, restrict, expel and restore companies.

Evidence anchor: Indian rulers.

Q32. Dubashes and brokers were important because they:

A. Replaced all Indian merchants. B. Issued Mughal farmans independently. C. Commanded the Portuguese Crown in Lisbon. D. Connected language, procurement, credit, customs and political access.

Answer: D. Explanation: Intermediation was a source of agency and conflict within port societies.

Evidence anchor: Brokers.

Q33. Why did bullion generally flow into India through company trade?

A. Indian exports often exceeded demand for European goods, requiring specie settlement. B. The cartaz required all ships to carry gold. C. Bullion was a Mughal tax on the VOC charter. D. India imported no commodities whatsoever.

Answer: A. Explanation: Favourable trade balances and Asian purchasing patterns explain the direction.

Evidence anchor: Bullion.

Q34. Which regional commodity pairing is safest?

A. Coromandel - no textiles. B. Bengal - cottons, silk and access to Bihar saltpetre. C. Malabar - only silver mines. D. Surat - exclusively tea.

Answer: B. Explanation: The pairing links port to hinterland without claiming exclusivity.

Evidence anchor: Commodities.

Q35. Saltpetre is especially associated with:

A. Bombay cotton mills in 1600. B. Pondicherry vineyards. C. Bihar-Patna supply networks feeding Bengal and company trade. D. Goa's Jesuit colleges alone.

Answer: C. Explanation: Saltpetre was a strategic export used in gunpowder production.

Evidence anchor: Saltpetre.

Q36. Which statement on shipbuilding is most accurate?

A. Europeans introduced all shipbuilding knowledge to India. B. Indian ships were prohibited from oceanic trade before 1498. C. The VOC never purchased Asian vessels. D. Indian yards built ships used by Indian merchants and European companies.

Answer: D. Explanation: Asian navigation and Indian productive skill coexisted with European artillery advantages.

Evidence anchor: Shipbuilding.

Q37. European port settlements should be understood as:

A. Layered urban spaces dependent on Indian labour, markets and authority despite fortified enclaves. B. Self-sufficient European islands with no hinterland links. C. Uniform cities built from one metropolitan plan. D. Pure military camps without trade.

Answer: A. Explanation: Walls separated jurisdiction more than economy.

Evidence anchor: Urban change.

Q38. Which is the safest cultural-causality statement?

A. Architecture was copied without Indian labour or materials. B. Maritime routes, mission institutions and local adaptation jointly shaped Portuguese cultural effects. C. Every crop arrived in a precisely known year. D. All cultural change resulted from one missionary.

Answer: B. Explanation: Cultural exchange needs chronology, institution, local agency and coercion cautions.

Evidence anchor: Cultural interaction.

Q39. Which site-style pairing is accurate?

A. Pulicat - Mughal capital. B. Bombay - Jesuit headquarters from 1498. C. Old Goa - Indo-Portuguese church ensemble; Pondicherry - French grid tradition. D. Calcutta - Portuguese Estado capital.

Answer: C. Explanation: The pairing uses material evidence without treating surviving fabric as unchanged.

Evidence anchor: Heritage.

Q40. Which event happened outside India but influenced English-Dutch strategy?

A. Hugli, 1632. B. Swally, 1612. C. Colachel, 1741. D. Amboyna, 1623.

Answer: D. Explanation: Amboyna intensified rivalry in the spice islands and encouraged English reorientation.

Evidence anchor: Rivalry.

Q41. Which cause should not stand alone in an explanation of Portuguese decline?

A. Religious intolerance. B. Strategic overextension. C. Asian resistance. D. Dutch-English competition.

Answer: A. Explanation: Religious coercion mattered, but decline also involved finance, war, shipping and regional politics.

Evidence anchor: Causal hierarchy.

Q42. Why did Dutch strength not become Indian territorial empire?

A. Indian textiles had no value in Asian trade. B. The VOC prioritised Indonesian monopoly while using India commercially. C. The Dutch had no factories in India. D. The Dutch company lacked any charter.

Answer: B. Explanation: Strategic portfolio choice explains commercial depth with territorial restraint.

Evidence anchor: Dutch outcome.

Q43. Why did the French lag the English politically?

A. France never formed an East India company. B. Dupleix refused all Indian alliances. C. Their Indian effort faced weaker naval-financial continuity and greater home-state strategic constraints. D. Pondicherry was a Portuguese base.

Answer: C. Explanation: The answer compares systems, not courage or nationality.

Evidence anchor: French outcome.

Q44. Which factor belongs to the later multiplier, not the original English foothold?

A. Surat permission. B. The 1639 Madras lease. C. The 1600 charter. D. Bengal revenue after Plassey and Diwani.

Answer: D. Explanation: Later Bengal resources cannot explain seventeenth-century settlement formation.

Evidence anchor: Timing.

Q45. The Danish presence is best used as:

A. A bounded comparison through Tranquebar and later Serampore without displacing the four-power spine. B. The main territorial conqueror of Bengal. C. The founder of Fort St George. D. The issuer of the Portuguese cartaz.

Answer: A. Explanation: Danish settlements show continued commercial plurality but limited political weight.

Evidence anchor: Danish comparison.

Q46. Which source claim requires the most caution?

A. A farman records an intended privilege. B. A company charter proves actual sovereignty over every claimed Asian territory. C. Factory records can document commodity orders. D. A fort can reveal spatial priorities.

Answer: B. Explanation: Legal claims and implementation must be compared.

Evidence anchor: Source criticism.

Q47. Which chronological order is correct?

A. VOC 1498 -> EIC 1510 -> Surat 1664 -> Madras 1717. B. French company 1498 -> EIC 1505 -> VOC 1510 -> Bombay 1530. C. EIC charter 1600 -> VOC 1602 -> Surat factory 1613 -> Madras 1639. D. Madras 1600 -> Surat 1602 -> Goa 1613 -> Calicut 1639.

Answer: C. Explanation: The sequence is a core recall ladder.

Evidence anchor: Chronology.

Q48. The company-state concept is most safely applied when:

A. A factory is equated with Diwani. B. Indian political authority is ignored. C. Every trader is assumed to be a state. D. Corporate public powers are distinguished from later enforceable territorial sovereignty.

Answer: D. Explanation: The concept clarifies mixed public-private power but can overstate early territorial control.

Evidence anchor: Historiography.

Q49. Which statement is correct about a factory?

A. It was a commercial depot and could exist without fortification. B. It automatically collected land revenue. C. It always manufactured textiles. D. It was identical to a presidency.

Answer: A. Explanation: This remedial item targets the most common terminology error.

Evidence anchor: Remedial terminology.

Q50. Which Xavier statement must be rejected?

A. He was a founding Jesuit. B. He died in Goa. C. His feast is celebrated in Goa. D. His remains are in Bom Jesus.

Answer: B. Explanation: Xavier died off China in 1552.

Evidence anchor: Remedial Xavier.

Q51. Which association is false?

A. Job Charnock - conventional Calcutta milestone. B. EIC - Bombay lease in 1668. C. Job Charnock - Bombay transfer. D. Charles II - Bombay Crown acquisition.

Answer: C. Explanation: Bombay and Calcutta origin stories must not be mixed.

Evidence anchor: Remedial Bombay.

Q52. What did the 1717 farman not do?

A. Create later customs disputes. B. Support Company claims around Calcutta. C. Expand Bengal privileges. D. Charter the EIC in England.

Answer: D. Explanation: The EIC charter dates to 1600.

Evidence anchor: Remedial farman.

Q53. Wandiwash 1760 was:

A. An Anglo-French battle in the later Carnatic transition. B. The Mughal capture of Hugli. C. The event that created the VOC. D. A Portuguese-Dutch battle for Goa.

Answer: A. Explanation: It is a bounded later event, not the core settlement chronology.

Evidence anchor: Remedial rivalry.

Q54. The Dutch in India were primarily:

A. Absent after 1623. B. Commercial actors integrated into an Indonesia-first VOC strategy. C. Territorial rulers of most of India. D. A branch of the French company.

Answer: B. Explanation: India remained important for textiles and bulk trade.

Evidence anchor: Remedial Dutch.

Q55. Which formulation is accurate?

A. It was a modern federal republic. B. It was the Dutch joint-stock company. C. The Estado da India was a Portuguese Crown network centred on nodal bases. D. It ruled continuous Indian territory.

Answer: C. Explanation: Political form and spatial reach must be stated precisely.

Evidence anchor: Remedial Estado.

Q56. Cartaz and farman differ because:

A. Both meant factory warehouses. B. Both were French urban grids. C. Both were English charters. D. Cartaz was a Portuguese maritime pass; farman was a sovereign Indian order.

Answer: D. Explanation: The distinction prevents cross-institution confusion This distinction is necessary for accurate UPSC elimination and chronology.

Evidence anchor: Remedial terms.

Q57. Which site pairing is correct?

A. Pulicat - Dutch; Pondicherry - French. B. Both were Mughal capitals. C. Pulicat - Portuguese; Pondicherry - English. D. Pulicat - French; Pondicherry - Dutch.

Answer: A. Explanation: Simple site-company precision underlies harder comparisons.

Evidence anchor: Remedial sites.

Q58. What was the broad direction of specie in early company trade?

A. Only the cartaz determined specie flows. B. Bullion generally entered India to pay for sought-after exports. C. No bullion moved in Asian trade. D. Bullion uniformly left India before any exports.

Answer: B. Explanation: Direction follows the trade balance, with regional and temporal variation.

Evidence anchor: Remedial bullion.

Q59. Fortification should be treated as:

A. Proof of complete inland sovereignty. B. A synonym for charter. C. A contingent step requiring resources and political tolerance, not automatic empire. D. A purely religious institution.

Answer: C. Explanation: Host rulers could ban, besiege or permit forts.

Evidence anchor: Remedial fortification.

Q60. The safest Calcutta formulation is:

A. A Portuguese capital captured in 1510. B. A Dutch spice island. C. An empty city founded solely by Charnock. D. A cumulative three-village settlement conventionally linked to Charnock's 1690 return.

Answer: D. Explanation: This avoids the founder myth while retaining the conventional date.

Evidence anchor: Remedial Calcutta.

Q61. Which sequence best avoids teleology in explaining European expansion in India?

A. Sea contact, negotiated trade, factory, fortification and possible sovereignty are distinct stages with additional conditions at every step. B. A European charter immediately created territorial sovereignty in India. C. Vasco da Gama's voyage predetermined British conquest. D. The first fortified post necessarily became a presidency and empire.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sea contact, negotiated trade, factory, fortification and possible sovereignty are distinct stages with additional conditions at every step.

Q62. What is the safest description of mercantilism in this topic?

A. It separated commerce completely from diplomacy and war. B. It linked chartered monopoly, protected commerce, naval force and state-company privilege. C. It meant that Asian merchants ceased trading after 1498. D. It prohibited every form of private trade by company servants.

Answer: B. Explanation: It linked chartered monopoly, protected commerce, naval force and state-company privilege.

Q63. Why did the Portuguese cartaz not amount to complete Indian Ocean monopoly?

A. It abolished Portuguese forts and naval patrols. B. It applied only to inland caravans. C. Its coercive reach was nodal and contested by long coastlines, rival fleets, evasion and Asian rulers. D. It was issued by Mughal emperors to the EIC.

Answer: C. Explanation: Its coercive reach was nodal and contested by long coastlines, rival fleets, evasion and Asian rulers.

Q64. Which statement correctly links St Francis Xavier to Goa?

A. He founded the Jesuit Order alone and died in Goa. B. He commanded the Portuguese cartaz fleet from Diu. C. He introduced a precisely dated crop package in a single year. D. He worked from Goa, was a founding Jesuit companion, died off China and has his tomb at Bom Jesus.

Answer: D. Explanation: He worked from Goa, was a founding Jesuit companion, died off China and has his tomb at Bom Jesus.

Q65. How should UNESCO's Churches and Convents of Goa record be used?

A. As evidence for missionary architecture, local adaptation, living heritage and conservation risk, not political causation. B. As a source for exact crop-transfer years. C. As proof that Portuguese sea control was complete. D. As proof that every Goan community accepted missionary policy uniformly.

Answer: A. Explanation: As evidence for missionary architecture, local adaptation, living heritage and conservation risk, not political causation.

Q66. What best explains the VOC's strong Indian trade but limited territorial ambition?

A. Indian rulers never permitted Dutch commerce. B. Indian textiles and bulk goods served a wider portfolio whose territorial priority lay in Indonesia. C. The Dutch abandoned all Indian factories immediately after Amboyna. D. The VOC lacked joint-stock capital or quasi-sovereign powers.

Answer: B. Explanation: Indian textiles and bulk goods served a wider portfolio whose territorial priority lay in Indonesia.

Q67. What does Child's War contribute to the argument?

A. It ended the Third Carnatic War. B. It gave the EIC the Diwani of Bengal. C. It demonstrates that a fortified company could still be defeated and compelled to submit to Mughal authority. D. It transferred Bombay from Portugal directly to the Company.

Answer: C. Explanation: It demonstrates that a fortified company could still be defeated and compelled to submit to Mughal authority.

Q68. Which institutional distinction is correct?

A. A fort automatically transferred its hinterland to the company. B. A factory was necessarily a manufacturing centre. C. A presidency was identical to a sovereign province from its first day. D. A charter created corporate powers at home, while a farman granted or confirmed privilege under an Indian sovereign.

Answer: D. Explanation: A charter created corporate powers at home, while a farman granted or confirmed privilege under an Indian sovereign.

Q69. Why is Job Charnock best handled cautiously?

A. The conventional 1690 association is useful, but Calcutta grew cumulatively from existing villages and actors. B. He commanded the French at Wandiwash. C. He founded Bombay after conquering it from Portugal. D. He issued the 1717 farman as Mughal emperor.

Answer: A. Explanation: The conventional 1690 association is useful, but Calcutta grew cumulatively from existing villages and actors.

Q70. What made the English coastal chain strategically useful before conquest?

A. The chain removed dependence on Indian merchants and producers. B. Surat, Madras, Bombay and Bengal diversified commodities, information, shipping and regional coordination. C. Every base was acquired by battlefield annexation. D. Bengal revenue financed the original 1600 charter.

Answer: B. Explanation: Surat, Madras, Bombay and Bengal diversified commodities, information, shipping and regional coordination.

Q71. Which statement best describes the French Compagnie des Indes?

A. It was expelled from every Indian factory by the Treaty of Paris. B. It focused exclusively on the Indonesian spice islands. C. It was a state-backed monopoly whose Indian bases and interventions were constrained by finance, naval support and home priorities. D. It was the Portuguese Crown's Estado da India.

Answer: C. Explanation: It was a state-backed monopoly whose Indian bases and interventions were constrained by finance, naval support and home priorities.

Q72. What transformed the Carnatic Wars from imported European conflict into Indian politics?

A. The Portuguese cartaz decided every Carnatic succession. B. The wars began only after the Company received the Bengal Diwani. C. Indian rulers played no part in choosing allies. D. European war intersected with Carnatic and Hyderabad claimant struggles and company-backed military service.

Answer: D. Explanation: European war intersected with Carnatic and Hyderabad claimant struggles and company-backed military service.

Q73. Which war-settlement pairing is correct?

A. The First Carnatic War ended with Aix-la-Chapelle, while the third phase closed with the Treaty of Paris. B. Aix-la-Chapelle granted the Company Bengal's Diwani. C. Wandiwash ended the First Carnatic War and restored Madras. D. Paris abolished all French commercial presence in India.

Answer: A. Explanation: The First Carnatic War ended with Aix-la-Chapelle, while the third phase closed with the Treaty of Paris.

Q74. Why is Wandiwash a bounded conclusion rather than Topic 03's starting point?

A. It explains the original Mughal permission for Surat. B. It concludes the Anglo-French political rivalry after the earlier settlement and institutional story has been established. C. It was the first Portuguese landing on the Malabar coast. D. It created the Dutch VOC.

Answer: B. Explanation: It concludes the Anglo-French political rivalry after the earlier settlement and institutional story has been established.

Q75. Which claim about Indian agency is most defensible?

A. Agency means every participant had equal bargaining power. B. Indian merchants disappeared from oceanic trade after 1498. C. Rulers, merchants, brokers, producers and labourers shaped access and survival even as power became unequal. D. European forts were economically independent of surrounding towns.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rulers, merchants, brokers, producers and labourers shaped access and survival even as power became unequal.

Q76. What is the best explanation for English relative advantage?

A. Portuguese religious policy alone decided every later contest. B. English ethnicity alone produced military superiority. C. Plassey revenue explains all seventeenth-century English factories. D. Finance, naval reach, a diversified base network, organisational continuity, Indian alliances and timing interacted.

Answer: D. Explanation: Finance, naval reach, a diversified base network, organisational continuity, Indian alliances and timing interacted.

Q77. Which PYQ distinction correctly identifies Broach?

A. Broach belonged to the early Surat-centred EIC factory network in the first quarter of the seventeenth century. B. Broach was the principal French base under Dupleix. C. Broach was a Dutch spice-island capital. D. Broach was the Portuguese name for Fort St George.

Answer: A. Explanation: Broach belonged to the early Surat-centred EIC factory network in the first quarter of the seventeenth century.

Q78. What is the safe crop-transfer formulation?

A. The crops demonstrate complete Portuguese command of Indian agriculture. B. Papaya, pineapple and guava reached India through Portuguese networks in the broad period tested by UPSC, without exact-year claims. C. UNESCO's Goa listing proves the crops' political route. D. All three crops have one securely proven introduction date.

Answer: B. Explanation: Papaya, pineapple and guava reached India through Portuguese networks in the broad period tested by UPSC, without exact-year claims.

Q79. Which conclusion respects Topic 03's boundary with Topic 04?

A. The 1717 farman should be treated as the Diwani grant. B. The Treaty of Paris made the Company Nawab of Bengal. C. European settlement and rivalry end with the Carnatic comparison; detailed Plassey and Buxar mechanics follow in Topic 04. D. Topic 03 should duplicate the whole Dual Government narrative.

Answer: C. Explanation: European settlement and rivalry end with the Carnatic comparison; detailed Plassey and Buxar mechanics follow in Topic 04.

Q80. What is the strongest comparative answer line for the four powers?

A. Commercial success automatically becomes territorial empire. B. A private company always defeats a Crown enterprise. C. All four powers followed an identical financial and naval model. D. Different institutions created different strategic options, but outcomes depended on Asian commerce, Indian politics, war and timing.

Answer: D. Explanation: Different institutions created different strategic options, but outcomes depended on Asian commerce, Indian politics, war and timing.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

PART II - Verified/routed PYQs, hard MCQs and remedial loops

- PYQ rule: exact local question text is used where readable. Unavailable official keys are retained and labelled INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY with confidence.
- MCQ rule: 48 hard + 12 remedial questions. Answer placement follows strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. through all 60 without consecutive repetition.
- Coverage: stages and terminology; Portuguese; Dutch; English; French; Indian agency; commodities; ports; cultural effects; rivalry; English advantage; historiography.
- The adjacent 2022 GS-I Mains question is included only as a bridge to the later fiscal-military Company and is explicitly bounded to Topic 05.

PYQ 01 - UPSC Prelims 2021 Q33: first-quarter EIC factories

- Question: In the first quarter of the seventeenth century, in which of the following was/were the factory/factories of the English East India Company located? 1. Broach 2. Chicacole 3. Trichinopoly. Options: (A) 1 only (B) 1 and 2 (C) 3 only (D) 2 and 3.
- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY: A, 1 only. Confidence: high.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Broach belonged to the early western factory network alongside Surat, Ahmedabad and Agra. Chicacole and Trichinopoly were not EIC factories in the specified first-quarter window. The elimination depends on time and institutional geography, not merely knowing later British centres.
- Why this earns marks: it tests the date window, identifies Broach within the Surat-centred network and avoids projecting later south-Indian expansion backward.

Study / provenance link: PYQ provenance: local official paper/routing ledger; inferred keys are never presented as official.

PYQ 02 - UPSC Prelims 2021 Q39: St Francis Xavier

- Question: Consider the statements: 1. St Francis Xavier was one of the founding members of the Jesuit Order. 2. He died in Goa and a church is dedicated to him there. 3. His feast is celebrated in Goa each year. Options: (A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only (C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3.
- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY: C, 1 and 3 only. Confidence: high.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Statement 1 is correct: Xavier was among the founding companions of the Society of Jesus. Statement 2 is false because he died in 1552 on Shangchuan Island off China, although his remains are preserved in Goa. Statement 3 is correct; the feast is celebrated annually in Goa.
- Why this earns marks: it separates place of death from place of burial and uses the exact institutional fact about the Jesuit Order.

Study / provenance link: PYQ provenance: local official paper/routing ledger; inferred keys are never presented as official.

PYQ 03 - UPSC Prelims 2022 Q59: Dutch, Portuguese and English settlements

- Question: Consider the statements: 1. The Dutch established factories/warehouses on the east coast on lands granted by Gajapati rulers. 2. Albuquerque captured Goa from the Bijapur Sultanate. 3. The EIC established a factory at Madras on land leased from a representative of the Vijayanagara empire. Options: (A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only (C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3.
- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY: B, 2 and 3 only. Confidence: high.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Statement 1 is incorrect: Pulicat and other Dutch east-coast bases are not safely attributed to grants by Gajapati rulers. Statement 2 is correct: Albuquerque captured Goa from Bijapur in 1510. Statement 3 is correct: the Madras lease came through a local Nayak authority linked to the Chandragiri/Vijayanagara political order.
- Why this earns marks: it verifies each ruler-company-place relationship and states the political chain behind the Madras lease without treating it as modern territorial cession.

Study / provenance link: PYQ provenance: local official paper/routing ledger; inferred keys are never presented as official.

PYQ 04 - UPSC Prelims 2025 Q75: Portuguese crop transfers

- Question: How many of papaya, pineapple and guava were introduced in India by the Portuguese in the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries? Options: (A) Only one (B) Only two (C) All three (D) None.
- OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: C, all three. UPSC Civil Services (Preliminary) Examination 2025, GS-I, Series A official key.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Papaya, pineapple and guava were all introduced through Portuguese maritime networks. The safe formulation is the official question's broad sixteenth-seventeenth-century window; do not assign an unsupported single year to each crop.
- Why this earns marks: it uses the locally held official key and adds the chronology caution needed to prevent overclaiming.

Study / provenance link: PYQ provenance: local official paper/routing ledger; inferred keys are never presented as official.

PYQ 05 - Adjacent bridge: UPSC GS-I Mains 2022 Q2

- Question: Why did the armies of the British East India Company - mostly comprising of Indian soldiers - win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons. (150 words, 10 marks)
- VERIFIED QUESTION TEXT FROM LOCAL OFFICIAL 2022 GS-I PAPER. Included as a bounded bridge; its full ownership lies in Modern Topic 05.
- Solved explanation / model answer: The Company converted a commercial network into a fiscal-military system. Presidency coordination joined Madras, Bombay and Bengal to oceanic reinforcement; standard drill, artillery organisation and regular cash payment sustained sepoy units. Named evidence includes Fort St George as an early garrison hub, Bengal revenue after the 1765 Diwani, and Indian bankers, suppliers and soldiers who enabled campaigning. By contrast, many rulers faced fragmented command, irregular payment, rival claimants and weak inter-state coordination. Yet defeat was not inevitable: Mysore checked the Company in the Second Anglo-Mysore War, Travancore defeated the Dutch at Colachel and the Marathas forced the Treaty of Salbai. The decisive advantage was therefore not European ethnicity or weapon ownership but the Company's integration of finance, logistics, naval mobility, command and Indian alliances over repeated wars.
- Why this earns marks: it answers 'why' through linked institutions, names fiscal and settlement evidence, keeps Indian agency central and qualifies consistency with major reverses.

Study / provenance link: PYQ provenance: local official paper/routing ledger; inferred keys are never presented as official.

PART III - Original solved 10/15/20-mark Mains practice

- Each model answer follows directive fidelity and claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation.
- Evidence density targets: at least 2-3 named units for 10 marks, 4-6 for 15 marks and 5-8 for 20 marks.
- Every answer ends with 'Why this earns marks' and a qualified conclusion rather than a generic summary.

Mains 10M-1 - Distinguish maritime exploration, trading presence, fortified settlement and territorial empire. (150 words)

- Thesis: These are cumulative but non-identical forms of power; confusing them makes conquest appear inevitable.
- Claim 1 -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Vasco da Gama's Calicut voyage in 1498 opened direct Portuguese sea contact. It changed routes and bargaining but gave no jurisdiction over Calicut.
- Claim 2 -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Surat 1613 was an EIC factory under Mughal permission - a warehouse-office-residence, not a manufacturing plant or province.
- Claim 3 -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Fort St George after the 1639 Madras lease protected stock, specie and staff and supported a regional council, but its hinterland remained politically negotiated.
- Claim 4 -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Territorial empire required revenue, army, alliances and victory; Bengal's post-1757 fiscal turn belongs later and cannot explain the 1600 charter.
- Conclusion: The stages describe expanding capability, not an automatic legal or causal sequence.

- Why this earns marks: it defines all four terms, attaches a named example to each, explains what each proves and explicitly rejects teleology.

Mains 10M-2 - Examine the Portuguese cartaz system and its limits. (150 words)

- Thesis: The cartaz made Portuguese commerce an armed claim to regulate the sea, yet it never created complete Indian Ocean monopoly.
- Claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Portuguese authorities required passes and could seize non-compliant ships, redirecting traffic and customs toward Diu, Goa or other nodes. Satish Chandra records merchant resentment at confiscation and compulsory customs at Diu. This treated shipping lanes as taxable political space. However, the Estado's manpower was thin, coastlines vast and Asian merchants capable of evasion or resistance.
- Claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Cannon-armed fleets and forts supported the system, while pressure on Mughal shipping extracted concessions. Yet Mughal capture of Portuguese Hugli in 1632, English victory at Swally in 1612 and Dutch expansion exposed its limits.
- Conclusion: Cartaz power was coercive and innovative but nodal, contested and dependent on diplomacy ashore.
- Why this earns marks: the answer defines the institution, names Diu-Hugli-Swally evidence, analyses mechanism and qualifies monopoly.

Mains 10M-3 - European settlements were co-produced by Indian agency. Explain. (150 words)

- Thesis: European companies supplied ships, capital and guns, but Indian rulers and port societies determined access, supply and political survival.
- Rulers: the Zamorin resisted Portuguese monopoly; Cochin allied with Portugal; Jahangir's government permitted Surat after English naval credibility; a local Nayak grant enabled Madras; Aurangzeb defeated the EIC in Child's War.
- Merchants and brokers: Virji Vohra, Armenian networks and dubashes supplied credit, information, procurement and customs mediation. Their interests could support, constrain or redirect a company.
- Producers and labour: Coromandel and Bengal weavers, shipbuilders, transporters and food suppliers made factories commercially viable. Fort walls never removed dependence on the surrounding town.
- Qualification: Agency operated within growing naval and corporate asymmetry; collaboration did not mean equal power.
- Conclusion: Before conquest, the settlement was a negotiated institution embedded in Indian sovereignty and economy.
- Why this earns marks: it integrates rulers, merchants and labour with five named examples and balances agency against asymmetry.

Mains 15M-1 - Explain why Dutch India remained commercially important but territorially secondary. (250 words)

- Thesis: Dutch strategy did not neglect India; it assigned Indian ports a commercial role inside an Indonesia-centred monopoly portfolio.
- Institution: the VOC charter of 1602 pooled capital and granted treaty, war and fortification powers. This made it a formidable company-state but did not dictate where it should conquer.
- Commercial engine: Pulicat and later Nagapattinam connected Coromandel textiles to intra-Asian trade; Surat linked Gujarat and West Asia; Chinsura and Bengal supplied silk, textiles and saltpetre. Indian cloth purchased Southeast Asian spices, so India was essential to VOC circulation.
- Strategic allocation: monopoly profits were concentrated in the Indonesian archipelago. Large Indian territorial commitments promised heavy military and political cost without the same monopoly logic.
- Indian politics: Nayaks, Mughal officials, merchants and weavers fixed land, customs and supply. Travancore's victory at Colachel in 1741 proved a regional state could defeat Dutch arms without ending Dutch commerce.
- Competition and qualification: Amboyna 1623 sharpened English-Dutch rivalry, while Bedara 1759 marked a later Bengal check. Yet Dutch factories survived; commercial contraction and political retreat were not identical.
- Conclusion: The Dutch outcome followed portfolio choice, local resistance and English competition - not simple commercial failure.

- Why this earns marks: it answers the apparent paradox, uses five bases/events, distinguishes strategic priority from capacity and avoids hindsight.

Mains 15M-2 - Trace the English coastal chain to the early eighteenth century and assess its significance. (250 words)

- Thesis: The EIC built a diversified network by petition, lease and Crown transfer before it possessed territorial sovereignty.
- West: the 1600 charter enabled trade, but Swally 1612 and Mughal permission produced Surat 1613. Roe's 1615-19 embassy confirmed commercial privileges. Surat connected Mughal Gujarat to Red Sea and Persian Gulf circuits.
- Coromandel: Masulipatnam 1611 supplied textiles. A local Nayak lease in 1639 enabled Madras, and Fort St George protected stock and coordinated a growing council. Indian weavers and dubashes remained indispensable.
- Bombay: Portuguese possession passed to the English Crown in 1661 and to the Company in 1668. Its harbour and defensibility supported the 1687 presidency shift from Surat.
- Bengal: factories at Hugli and Kasimbazar preceded the cumulative three-village Calcutta settlement associated with 1690. Fort William and the 1698 zamindari rights strengthened the hub; Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman enlarged privileges.
- Significance: multiple bases diversified commodity access, information and naval reinforcement. Limitation: Child's War showed Mughal superiority; each base remained dependent on Indian rulers, merchants and labour.
- Conclusion: The chain created capacity for later intervention but not its inevitability.
- Why this earns marks: it traces four coasts chronologically, distinguishes legal routes and ends with both significance and a named reversal.

Mains 15M-3 - Assess the cultural and material effects of the Portuguese presence in India. (250 words)

- Thesis: Portuguese influence outlasted their commercial primacy because maritime, missionary and urban institutions moved plants, print, religious practices and architectural forms; effects were creative and coercive.
- Religion: Francis Xavier reached Goa in 1542 as a founding Jesuit; his remains at Bom Jesus became a lasting devotional centre. Mission schools and orders institutionalised Catholic presence. Yet the Goa Inquisition from 1560 and coercive policy require a power-sensitive account.
- Print: the Goa press of 1556, conventionally India's first, linked movable type to missionary education and language work. Its significance was institutional diffusion, not immediate mass literacy.
- Biological transfer: the official 2025 UPSC key confirms papaya, pineapple and guava as Portuguese introductions in the sixteenth-seventeenth centuries. Chronologies for individual crops should not be over-specified.
- Architecture and society: ASI/UNESCO identify Old Goa's churches, including Bom Jesus and Se Cathedral, as major ensembles. European forms were adapted by local materials and artisans; mixed communities and maritime vocabulary also developed.
- Qualification: influence varied by region and did not erase existing cultures. Missions, trade, intermarriage, local patronage and resistance worked simultaneously.
- Conclusion: Portuguese decline was territorial-commercial, not cultural disappearance.
- Why this earns marks: the answer gives four dimensions, five dated/site anchors, a coercion counterpoint and chronology cautions.

Mains 20M-1 - Why did the English eventually gain relative advantage over the Portuguese, Dutch and French? Reject monocausal and teleological explanations. (250 words)

- Thesis: English advantage emerged from a contingent bundle - finance, navy, diversified bases, organisational continuity, Indian alliances and timing - rather than an innate national superiority or destiny fixed in 1600.
- Finance and state: shareholder capital, London credit, private trade and later the English fiscal-naval state sustained repeated voyages and war. Yet the EIC remained dependent on royal charter and naval protection; it was not purely private.
- Network: Surat, Madras, Bombay and Bengal diversified commodities and risk. Bombay's harbour, Fort St George's council and Bengal's textile-credit depth created mutually supporting nodes.

- Rival structures: the Portuguese Estado was overextended and resource-thin; VOC strategy rationally prioritised Indonesia; French India faced discontinuous naval-financial support and stronger home-state interference. These were strategic constraints, not stereotypes.
- Indian agency: Mughal permissions, Nayak leases, merchants, bankers, dubashes, sepoys and suppliers enabled English growth. Child's War and Indian victories such as Colachel prove that European triumph was never automatic.
- Timing: Bengal revenue after Plassey and Diwani later financed war, but cannot explain seventeenth-century footholds. It was a multiplier after political breakthrough.
- Conclusion: the EIC gained relative advantage because it learned, survived reverses and connected corporate and state resources to Indian political openings more consistently than rivals.
- Why this earns marks: it compares all four powers through common variables, separates early and late causes, centres Indian actors and directly rejects inevitability.

Mains 20M-2 - Compare the political structures and business models of the four major European powers in India. (250 words)

- Thesis: institutional design shaped strategic options, but outcomes arose only when design interacted with geography, home-state priorities and Indian politics.
- Portuguese: the Estado da India was a Crown network of viceroy, fleets, forts and royal factories. Cartaz coercion suited chokepoints, but monopoly rigidity, thin resources and religious conflict limited adaptation.
- Dutch: the 1602 VOC was a heavily capitalised joint-stock company with quasi-sovereign powers. Pulicat, Nagapattinam, Surat and Bengal supplied textiles and bulk goods to an Indonesia-first intra-Asian portfolio; India remained commercial rather than territorial priority.
- English: the 1600 EIC joined shareholder finance, private trade and a growing presidency system. Surat, Madras, Bombay and Calcutta produced a diversified network, though all early bases rested on permission, lease or transfer.
- French: the 1664 Compagnie des Indes combined monopoly trade with close royal sponsorship. Pondicherry and Chandernagore became capable hubs; Dupleix exploited claimant politics, but finance and naval support were less continuous.
- Comparison and limit: 'private versus state' is too crude - every company used public power and every company contained private interest. Indian rulers and merchants mediated all four.
- Conclusion: the English model proved relatively resilient, not universally superior; Dutch Indonesian success and Portuguese cultural durability require different measures of outcome.
- Why this earns marks: it compares through political form, finance, bases, strategy and limits, then qualifies the categories.

Mains 20M-3 - 'A factory could become a fort, but a fort did not have to become an empire.' Critically discuss. (250 words)

- Thesis: the statement captures a conditional sequence. Commercial protection could generate fortification, but territorial sovereignty required additional fiscal, military and political transformations.
- Factory stage: Surat 1613 functioned under Mughal permission; Masulipatnam and Hugli linked company buyers to textile hinterlands. Factory meant depot and agents, not manufacture or province.
- Fortification: Fort St George after the 1639 Madras lease and Fort William in the 1690s protected stock, specie and staff and expanded internal jurisdiction. Yet host rulers could prohibit walls: Bengal nawabs repeatedly contested fortification.
- Regional coordination: Bombay's 1687 presidency shift and Madras councils improved information, shipping and garrison management. Administrative capacity created an option for intervention.
- Missing conditions: a company still needed durable finance, trained troops, Indian allies, political crisis, victory and revenue. Child's War showed that a fortified company could be defeated; Dutch factories remained commercial; Portuguese enclaves survived without expanding empire.
- Later bridge: Carnatic claimant politics and Bengal revenue converted military service into political and fiscal leverage. These were contingent conjunctures, not charter consequences.

- Conclusion: forts were infrastructure of possibility. Empire emerged only when corporate capacity met Indian political fragmentation and a fiscal breakthrough.
- Why this earns marks: it tests the quotation stage by stage, deploys successful and failed examples and identifies the missing causal conditions.